

Although most grasses look similar, some have unique features that make them stand out. While **bamboos** grow woody stems that allow some species to reach up to 160 ft (50 m) in height, the **Antarctic hair grass** lives in such a harsh, cold climate that it grows only a few centimeters tall. Most grasses come in shades of green, but some are popular for

their colors, such as the red leaves of the **Japanese bloodgrass** and the blue-gray foliage of the **blue fescue**. The red flower spikes of the **hair-awn muhly grass** add a splash of color to gardens, while many people grow **pampas grass** for their tall, feathery flower spikes, which blow in the wind.



These fluffy flower tufts are popular with gardeners.

Hares-tail grass

TALL AND USEFUL

Elephant grass can grow into a tall plant quickly, without needing much water or food. Thriving even in poor soil conditions, African elephant grass is used as fodder for cattle and elephants. It is also planted to prevent soil erosion in dry or overgrazed lands. Scientists have explored the use of the Asian variety of this grass as a biofuel, burning it to produce electricity.



13 ft (4 m)

The flattened flower spikes are just 1/3 in (1 cm) long.

Spangle grass

Flower spikes look like fluffy pink clouds.

Hair-awn muhly grass



Soft flower spikes look like gray bottle brushes.

Oriental fountain grass

Japanese bloodgrass

This tall grass can reach 9 3/4 in (3 m) in height.

Pampas grass

Bloodred leaf tips fade to bright green at the bottom.

